

TIMELINE

August 27, 1908 Born on a farm at Stonewall, Texas, the son of Sam and Rebekah Baines Johnson.

1924 Graduates from Johnson City High School.

1927–30 Trains and works as a teacher.

1931 Employed as an aide to Texan Democratic Congressman Richard Kleberg.

November 17, 1934 Marries Claudia Alta Taylor, known as “Lady Bird.”

1935 Appointed head of the Texas National Youth Administration, a New Deal agency.

1937 Contests a special election and enters the House of Representatives, where he serves until 1949.

December 1941–July 1942 On active service in the US Naval Reserve; flew one combat mission.

1944 Birth of first child Linda Bird Johnson; second child Luci Baines Johnson born 1947.

1948 Elected to the Senate.

1953 Becomes leader of the Democratic minority in the Senate.

1957 Enables passage of the Civil Rights Act through Congress.

January 20, 1961 Takes office as vice president under President Kennedy.

November 22, 1963 Sworn in as US President after Kennedy is assassinated.

July 1964 Signs the Civil Rights Act to target racial discrimination.

August 7, 1964 Gulf of Tonkin resolution authorizes Johnson to escalate military operations in Vietnam.

November 3, 1964 Elected for a full term as president.

February 13, 1965 Orders the bombing of North Vietnam.

April 1965 Authorizes use of ground troops in combat operations in Vietnam.

March 31, 1968 Halts bombing in Vietnam north of the 20th parallel and announces he will not seek reelection.

22 January 1973 Dies in Stonewall, Texas, aged 64; given a state funeral.



JOHNSON'S CAMPAIGN FOR PRESIDENCY

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